

My Beginning of Code

Andre Guzman - 7/15/2026

Introduction

Before I started learning to code, I thought it was going to be the hardest thing in the world, and I only saw it as something needing a team of specialists... and I still do, as I have not yet mastered every aspect of the coding process. However, throughout the internship at Choicest Fruit, I have developed new understandings and perspectives on the world of programming.

What I Learned

At first, I thought it wasn't for me, that it couldn't be relevant to my interests of making art and writing stories. But it was. I learned that coding wasn't just about making stuff functional; it is also about translating your ideas into something real. For example, I was able to create a site about a choose-your-own-adventure game, which I was able to turn into something that matched my thoughts and ideas.

I've learned that coding is not only just about using formats like HTML or JavaScript; it's also about keeping your hard work in a safe place. When I was using the Visual Studio Code application, I had to create a Repository in GitHub to make sure I didn't lose my work. I learned I needed to commit and push my code into my GitHub account so I could retrieve it whenever I wanted. However, I didn't know this was possible or necessary at first, so I risked losing my progress. Fortunately, I found out about this and made sure to always push my code to GitHub.

In relation to my code, I worked with the Visual Studio Code application and used three coding branches: HTML, used for structuring; CSS, used to control the visual elements; and JavaScript, used to make interactive and responsive content. These branches work together to create your site and are what allows you to get creative when coding.

I have also developed skills like using my critical thinking to write code and using AI in ethical ways. I first write out as much code as could and use AI to offer suggestions and give me feedback. I then use the response to improve my coding and expanding projects, such as my portfolio website and personal project. This technique allows me to use my own brain power while also using AI to assist me to code.

Problems I Faced and Solved

Of course, it wasn't just a walk in the park during the internship; I definitely struggled a lot with GitHub and using the code. Most of the time during the internship, I would just get lost just trying to figure out the commands in the terminal, getting confused why it won't work. I also had

trouble getting my code to function and tried so many different attempts but couldn't get JavaScript to work. Fortunately, with helpful research and asking the advisor for help, I was able to solve the problem. I also communicated with my interns to ask for help, and they all gave me valuable information, such as tips on using JavaScript or fast ways I can debug.

Advice I'd Give to Other Beginners

As I progress in my journey of code, I would like to offer useful advice to fellow beginners like you. These tips will not only help you problem-solve, but they will also give you advice on communication and ethical use in AI. Here are some of my thought-out tips:

- Don't fear mistakes: like any skill, you can learn from your mistakes. You can use the error in code as a hint that shows you where to improve.
- Break down problems: if you encounter a problem, divide it into a step-by-step process to solve it, ensuring that you will learn as you go.
- Ask for help: when you're stuck rewriting the same code, don't just sit there; ask someone who knows for help, research a solution, or ask AI for assistance.
- Use AI ethically: don't just copy and paste; ask AI to give you suggestions on the next step or use it to polish up your code and improve it.
- Speak up: when working with a group to write code, make sure you properly communicate and discuss your role in the project.

Conclusion

In conclusion, my journey into the world of coding has unlocked a new interest for me. While I initially saw coding as a tough task, my experiences at Choicest Fruit have taught me that it is not only accessible but also connected with creativity and expression. As I continue to enhance my skills, I am grateful for the lessons I learned and the support I received from my peers. The challenges I encountered have only strengthened my ability to use tech practically and professionally. I hope that by sharing my experiences with fellow beginners, I can inspire others to embrace coding confidently and creatively. The possibilities are vast, and I am excited to see where this path will lead me next.